

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-III.6: Gospels: Narrative, Speech, and Biblical Idiom

Track participants, speech levels, narrative tense, participles, and biblical coordination through a connected Gospel passage

A self-contained learning packet with a local reference card, enriched submodules, selected handwritten practice, a mastery record, and matching answers. This working study is not an official liturgical book or approved curriculum.

Corpus	1962 <i>Missale Romanum</i> ; Vulgate and ecclesiastical prose as supporting readers
Method	Print, annotate, parse, copy, transform, translate, and compose by hand
Pacing	Advance by demonstrated mastery; module packets use two focused sessions as a planning envelope
Document	Learning module; learner and terminal-key edition
Triptych: AI Driven Studies in Catholic Faith, Worship, and Law	

Contents

I	Module Plan and Reference	1
1	Plan, prerequisites, and advancement decision1	
1.1	Two focused sessions	1
2	Module reference card1	
2.1	Terms, forms, and decisions to retrieve	1
2.2	High-risk contrast	2
2.3	Working protocol	2
II	Core Lesson	3
1	Gospels: Narrative, Speech, and Biblical Idiom3	
1.1	Repetition as theological precision	3
1.2	Impersonal frame and result	3
1.3	Participles and a moving subject	4
1.4	The first day of the week	4
III	Enrichment by Submodule	5
1	Connections, transfer, and retrieval5	
1.1	Repetition as theological precision — enrichment and transfer	5
1.2	Impersonal frame and result — enrichment and transfer	5
1.3	Participles and a moving subject — enrichment and transfer	5
1.4	The first day of the week — enrichment and transfer	5
IV	Selected Practice	6
V	Mastery Decision	9
1	Mastery and error record9	
VI	Answer Key	10
1	How to Use the Keys102 Enrichment models and rubrics103 Selected worksheet solutions11	
VII	Scope and Sources	13
1	Scope and Qualifications13	
1.1	Packet boundary	13
1.2	Corpus, text, and limits	13
1.3	Review, rights, and release state	13
2	References13	
2.1	Primary corpus	14
2.2	Grammar and lexicography	14
2.3	Citation convention	14
3	Generation Metadata14	

Part I

Module Plan and Reference

CHAPTER 1

Plan, prerequisites, and advancement decision

Module ID	EL-III.6
Course stage	Stage III — Independent Missal Reading
Prerequisites	EL-III.5 and control of argument and speaker maps
Observable outcome	Track participants, speech levels, narrative tense, participles, and biblical coordination through a connected Gospel passage
Printed practice	Worksheets III.22 (Lucan narrative chain, Variant B) and III.24 (biblical idiom gate, Variant D), with terminal keys
Extension bank	Worksheets III.21 and III.23 remain optional Johannine-repetition and direct-speech practice
Next dependency	EL-III.7, Chants and Sequences

1.1 Two focused sessions

Session 1 — guided acquisition. Build a participant-and-tense ledger from the Lucan narrative and complete Worksheet III.22.

Session 2 — transfer and gate. Apply the ledger to biblical idiom and predicative participles in Worksheet III.24, then give a direct narrative summary.

The two-session plan is a workload envelope, not permission to advance by elapsed time. Stop, correct in a different color, and use an omitted variant when the mastery evidence below is absent.

Advance when: On a fresh Gospel paragraph, keep every participant and speaker stable, classify narrative and discourse forms, attach participles, and explain repeated coordination without turning every form into the same English tense or connector.

CHAPTER 2

Module reference card

2.1 Terms, forms, and decisions to retrieve

- participant, speaker, addressee, quotation boundary, and pronoun chain;
- narrative perfect, imperfect background, historical present, and relative time;
- impersonal frame, result or event clause, and predicative participle; and
- repeated coordination whose precise discourse relation remains contextual.

2.2 High-risk contrast

A stable grammatical subject may persist across several verbs while the discourse speaker changes inside direct speech; neither continuity may be guessed from the nearest noun alone.

2.3 Working protocol

Before looking anything up, mark the finite verb or verbal center, propose dictionary forms, and record at least two formally possible readings where an ending is syncretic. Use the identified 1962 Missal and the course source record for received wording. A familiar English rendering does not replace a parse.

Part II

Core Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Gospels: Narrative, Speech, and Biblical Idiom

On completing this unit, you can:

- separate narrative frame, reported speech, and narrator comment;
- track participants through pronouns, participles, and shifts of subject;
- recognize common Semitic patterns without declaring them meaningless idioms.

The heading *In illo tempore* gives the liturgical reading a frame but does not connect syntactically to the first Gospel verb. Draw quotation bars in the margin whenever speech begins and ends. Within a quotation, re-establish the speaker and addressee before resolving *ego*, *tu*, *hic*, *ille*, or reflexive *se*.

The **narrative frame** locates or introduces the narrated event; the **narrator** is the discourse voice that presents events but is not thereby a participant in them. **Direct speech** reproduces a speaker's words as a quotation, whereas **reported speech** makes those words depend grammatically on a reporting verb. A **biblical idiom** is a recurrent expression characteristic of scriptural Latin, sometimes reflecting Hebrew or Greek usage; calling it an idiom describes established use, not absence of grammar.

1.1 Repetition as theological precision

Omnia per ipsum facta sunt: et sine ipso factum est nihil, quod factum est.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), In Nativitate Domini, ad tertiam Missam in die, Evangelium (Io. 1:3).

Neuter plural *omnia* is the subject of plural *facta sunt*; *per ipsum* expresses agency or mediation. In the second member, *nihil* is singular and therefore takes *factum est*. The final relative *quod factum est* restricts the created totality. Preserve the repetition of *factum*: replacing every occurrence with a different English synonym obscures the argument.

1.2 Impersonal frame and result

Factum est autem, cum essent ibi, impleti sunt dies ut pareret. Et peperit filium suum primogenitum, et pannis eum involvit, et reclinavit eum in præsepio.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), In Nativitate Domini, ad primam Missam in nocte, Evangelium (Lc. 2:6–7).

factum est is an impersonal narrative hinge. The temporal *cum*-clause takes subjunctive *essent*; the main event is *impleti sunt dies*. The clause *ut pareret* is an epexegetic result/content clause explaining what the completion of the days amounted to: the time for her to give birth. Thereafter the repeated subject remains Mary: *peperit*, *involvit*, *reclinavit*. The pronoun *eum* twice returns to *filium*; *pannis* is ablative of wrapping or means and *in præsepio* location.

1.3 Participles and a moving subject

Cum natus esset Iesus in Bethlehem Iuda in diebus Herodis regis, ecce Magi ab oriente venerunt Ierosolymam, dicentes: Ubi est qui natus est Rex Iudæorum?

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), In Epiphania Domini, Evangelium (Mt. 2:1–2).

The circumstantial *cum*-clause has *Iesus* as subject; the main subject then shifts to *Magi*. *Ierosolymam* is accusative of motion toward without a preposition. Present participle *dicentes* agrees with the *Magi* and opens their direct speech. In the question, substantival *qui natus est* is the subject and *Rex* its predicate nominative; the capital letters do not determine syntax.

1.4 The first day of the week

Una autem sabbati, Maria Magdalene venit mane, cum adhuc tenebræ essent, ad monumentum: et vidit lapidem sublatum a monumento.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), Sabbato in Albis, Evangelium (Io. 20:1).

una sabbati is biblical idiom: “one [day] of the week,” hence the first day. Supply *die* only as an explanatory ellipsis, not as though it were printed. The temporal *cum*-clause takes *essent*. In *lapidem sublatum*, the participle is predicative: she saw the stone in a removed state; *a monumento* marks separation.

Advance when: on an unseen Gospel of 250–400 words, you mark speech boundaries, track every participant through sampled pronouns and participles, explain each subjunctive, and answer eight factual and causal questions in simple Latin with at least 85% content accuracy, using no facing translation and at most ten lookups after the first pass.

Part III

Enrichment by Submodule

CHAPTER 1

Connections, transfer, and retrieval

1.1 Repetition as theological precision — enrichment and transfer

Connection. Repeated roots can bind clauses and propositions even when polished English would vary the vocabulary.

Transfer task. On the lesson's repeated-word example, underline every recurrence, give each form's morphology and function, and state what remains constant or develops.

Retrieval check. Name one reason not to replace all repetitions with English synonyms during analysis.

1.2 Impersonal frame and result — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A narrative frame and the event it introduces are separate grammatical layers.

Transfer task. Bracket the lesson's impersonal frame, then indent the event or result clause and identify the tense and mood of each verbal center.

Retrieval check. State which element carries the story event's propositional content.

1.3 Participles and a moving subject — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A participant ledger prevents a participle from being attached to the most recent noun by proximity.

Transfer task. For Worksheet III.22, make one row per participant and place every participle and finite verb under its controlled subject.

Retrieval check. For one participle, give case, gender, number, voice, and relative time.

1.4 The first day of the week — enrichment and transfer

Connection. Time expressions and narrative sequence must be parsed before a chronology is paraphrased.

Transfer task. Using the lesson's printed resurrection narrative, label every time expression, motion phrase, completed action, and reported observation.

Retrieval check. Distinguish time-when from duration or motion in one sentence.

Part IV

Selected Practice

Unit III.6 — Gospels

III.6 — Variant B

Worksheet ID: III.22

Focus: Lucan narrative chain

Use: Track the stable subject.

1. **Text:** *Factum est autem, cum essent ibi, impleti sunt dies ut pareret. Et peperit filium suum primogenitum, et pannis eum involvit, et reclinavit eum in præsepio.*

Passage ID: III.22.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Separate frame, main event, and three actions.

-
2. Identify the mood and reason of *essent* and *pareret*.

-
3. What is the antecedent of each *eum*?

-
4. Change the three perfect actions to present narrative.

-
5. Answer in Latin: *Ubi puer reclinatus est?*

-
6. Write a participant chain using only nominatives and arrows to objects.
-

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction's rule.

III.6 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: III.24

Focus: Biblical idiom and predicative participle

Use: Do not turn a state into a second event.

1. **Text:** *Una autem sabbati, Maria Magdalene venit mane, cum adhuc tenebræ essent, ad monumentum: et vidit lapidem sublatum a monumento.*

Passage ID: III.24.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Explain the opening idiom, temporal clause, and perception construction.

-
2. Why is *sabbati* genitive singular?

-
3. Distinguish *mane* from a declined adjective in this clause.

-
4. Rewrite *vidit lapidem sublatum* as a finite subordinate clause without changing core sense.

-
5. Answer in Latin: *Quando et quo Maria venit?*

-
6. Give lemma and full morphology of *sublatum*.
-

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction's rule.

Part V**Mastery Decision****CHAPTER 1**

Mastery and error record

Complete this page before opening the answer part.

Evidence	Session 1	Session 2 / delayed check
Date and elapsed focused time		
Worksheet ID and score		
One rule retrieved without notes		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or delayed item used		

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:**

Reason in one complete sentence:

Part VI

Answer Key

CHAPTER 1

How to Use the Keys

These keys diagnose grammatical decisions. Compare them only after completing the corresponding worksheet or assessment in ink. For a closed item, locate the form, function, government, or clause relation that decides the answer; a matching English paraphrase alone is not enough. For an open task, use the stated model and rubric to test morphology, syntax, idiom, and source control.

Some translations legitimately admit more than one English wording. An alternative is acceptable when it preserves the Latin agency, negation, time, dependency, and material ambiguity. Record a defensible alternative in the error ledger rather than changing it merely to imitate the model's style.

CHAPTER 2

Enrichment models and rubrics

Repetition as theological precision — model and rubric

Connection. Repeated roots can bind clauses and propositions even when polished English would vary the vocabulary.

Model / acceptable evidence. The model preserves the repeated Latin lemma while distinguishing each form's clause role. Variation in English may be stylistic, but it must not conceal the source's lexical linkage.

Impersonal frame and result — model and rubric

Connection. A narrative frame and the event it introduces are separate grammatical layers.

Model / acceptable evidence. The frame remains outside the subordinate event clause; the latter carries the event content. A model that translates the frame as the event without mapping the clause fails.

Participles and a moving subject — model and rubric

Connection. A participant ledger prevents a participle from being attached to the most recent noun by proximity.

Model / acceptable evidence. Every verbal form belongs to the row supported by agreement and narrative reference. The participle parse must match its controller in case, gender, and number and state time relative to its finite verb.

The first day of the week — model and rubric

Connection. Time expressions and narrative sequence must be parsed before a chronology is paraphrased.

Model / acceptable evidence. The model cites the case or preposition governing each expression and orders events from finite forms and connectors. A devotional recollection without those forms is not sufficient.

CHAPTER 3

Selected worksheet solutions

Unit III.6 — Gospels

III.6 — Variant B

Worksheet ID: III.22

Focus: Lucan narrative chain

Use: Track the stable subject.

1. **Text:** *Factum est autem, cum essent ibi, impleti sunt dies ut pareret. Et peperit filium suum primogenitum, et pannis eum involvit, et reclinavit eum in præsepio.*

Passage ID: III.22.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Separate frame, main event, and three actions.

Answer / notes: Impersonal frame *factum est*; temporal *cum essent ibi*; main *impleti sunt dies* with result/content *ut pareret*. Mary remains subject of perfects *peperit*, *involvit*, *reclinavit*; *filium* object, then *eum* twice; *pannis* means, *in præsepio* location.

2. Identify the mood and reason of *essent* and *pareret*.

Answer / model: Both imperfect subjunctive: *essent* in a narrative circumstantial temporal *cum*-clause; *pareret* in the clause expressing the completion/result for the days.

3. What is the antecedent of each *eum*?

Answer / model: *filium suum primogenitum*.

4. Change the three perfect actions to present narrative.

Answer / model: *parit filium suum primogenitum, pannis eum involvit, et reclinat eum in præsepio.*

5. Answer in Latin: *Ubi puer reclinatus est?*

Answer / model: *Puer in præsepio reclinatus est.*

6. Write a participant chain using only nominatives and arrows to objects.

Answer / model: Model: *Maria -> filium parit; Maria -> eum pannis involvit; Maria -> eum in præsepio reclinat.*

III.6 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: III.24

Focus: Biblical idiom and predicative participle

Use: Do not turn a state into a second event.

1. **Text:** *Una autem sabbati, Maria Magdalene venit mane, cum adhuc tenebræ essent, ad monumentum: et vidit lapidem sublatum a monumento.*

Passage ID: III.24.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Explain the opening idiom, temporal clause, and perception construction.

Answer / notes: *una sabbati*: first/one day of the week, with explanatory [*die*] possible but not printed. Temporal *cum ... essent* has imperfect subjunctive. Mary is subject of perfects *venit/vidit*; destination *ad monumentum*. *lapidem sublatum* is object plus predicative participle: she saw the stone in a removed state; *a monumento* separation.

2. Why is *sabbati* genitive singular?

Answer / model: Biblical/Semitic idiom counts a day of the week; the genitive names the week/Sabbath cycle.

3. Distinguish *mane* from a declined adjective in this clause.

Answer / model: It is an indeclinable adverb/noun used adverbially, “early/in the morning,” modifying *venit*.

4. Rewrite *vidit lapidem sublatum* as a finite subordinate clause without changing core sense.

Answer / model: *vidit quod lapis a monumento sublatus erat* is a defensible explicit reformulation, though less compact.

5. Answer in Latin: *Quando et quo Maria venit?*

Answer / model: *Maria mane, cum adhuc tenebræ essent, ad monumentum venit.*

6. Give lemma and full morphology of *sublatum*.

Answer / model: From *tollo, tollere, sustuli, sublatum*; perfect passive participle accusative masculine singular agreeing with *lapidem*.

Part VII

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-III.6, *Gospels: Narrative, Speech, and Biblical Idiom*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative teaching unit, its local reference decisions, enrichment for each internal submodule, the selected worksheets named in the module plan, and the matching solutions. The selected Lucan and idiom-focused work is representative genre practice, not a survey of every Gospel's style.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. Two focused sessions describe the packet's planned core, while the mastery gate and delayed recall determine advancement.

1.2 Corpus, text, and limits

The controlling reader is the 1962 typical edition of the *Missale Romanum*; the identified Clementine Vulgate and other ecclesiastical prose are supporting corpora. Running Latin normally uses consonantal *i*, the ligature *æ*, and no macrons. Received excerpts may normalize typography but are not diplomatic transcriptions unless labeled. Uncited short drills, transformations, and instructional models are project-composed; English translations and glosses are project translations unless identified otherwise.

This packet teaches language competence. It is not an official liturgical book, approved seminary curriculum, certification, pronunciation or ceremonial course, critical edition, or authority for a liturgical, theological, textual, or canonical judgment. Check received wording against the editions identified in the course-wide passage inventory.

1.3 Review, rights, and release state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and enrichment. No independent Latinist, liturgist, pedagogue, theologian, or ecclesiastical reviewer is claimed. Page-image collation and the donor and liturgical-text distribution bases remain unresolved pre-installation gates. The packet therefore remains a working build on hold, not an installed or released publication.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source

roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.
- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-20T21:32:44Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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